

Labor & Employment	
Article	[optional]
Ethics and discrimination in artificial intelligence-enabled recruitment practices. https://www.nature.com/articles/s41599-023-02079-x • discuss job market discrimination theories in the context of developing technologies • a literature review approach was employed to examine the factors contributing to discrimination in algorithmic hiring • study technical and managerial approaches to mitigating algorithmic discrimination	
AI Recruitment	• AI tools are used to help with hiring ○ decrease screening times ○ candidate ranking ○ effort deduplication ○ efficiency gains
Algorithmic Bias	• AI bias occurs with decisions disproportionately disadvantage certain groups • discrimination can occur based on ○ gender ○ race ○ skin tone ○ personality preferences
Why Bias Happens	• training data ○ AI learns from real data ○ real human bias is absorbed through training • designer intention ○ humans choose what data and features to include ○ bias can be introduced intentionally or unintentionally • algorithm errors ○ even well-thought-out models can develop biases
Examples of Bias	• systems downgrading resumes from women • chatbots learning racist responses from social media data • facial recognition misidentifying darker skin tones
Ways to Reduce Bias	• technical solutions ○ use fair and balanced datasets

	○ increase algorithm transparency ○ build tools that explain their decisions • managerial & policy solutions ○ better company ethics education ○ responsible oversight and governance ○ external audits by independent groups
Conclusion	• AI can help hiring, but only if bias is carefully monitored and corrected • when AI training data or design reflects existing inequalities, it can reproduce discrimination
Podcast	
Eliminating Algorithmic Bias in Hiring and Employment	
• <i>Work-ology Podcast</i> E224 • host: Jessical Miller-Merrell • guest: Steve Feyer • this episode discusses AI tools being used in hiring identifying and mitigating bias in machine learning algorithms	
AI in Hiring	• AI tools help with parts of the hiring process including: ○ finding and advertising jobs to candidates ○ screening resumes ○ sorting people based on data ○ helping recruiters make decisions faster • these tools are meant to make hiring more efficient
Where Bias Can Happen	• AI tools learn patterns from data ○ AI can repeat those unfair decisions ○ this can disproportionately harm certain groups ▪ gender ▪ race ▪ age ▪ ability • AI doesn't "decide" on its own, limit exposure for certain demographics ○ limiting accessibility to high-value listings by filtering job ads ○ downgrading their ranking
Risks of	• limit visibility of job postings for some groups

Bias in AI	• reinforce unfair patterns already present in the workplace • create environments that allow unintentional discrimination
Solutions & Advice	• do not assume that AI will always be fair • employers and developers can promote education and awareness to prevent the introduction of bias • laws in some places require explanation, so candidates know why decisions were made • balance fairness, efficiency, and lack of bias when building or choosing tools
Article	
New Research on AI and Fairness in Hiring https://hbr.org/2025/12/new-research-on-ai-and-fairness-in-hiring • <i>Harvard Business Review</i> 2025 • authors: Elmira van den Broek Anastasia V. Sergeeva Marleen Huysman • nearly 90% of companies now use AI in hiring decisions	
Two Common Beliefs About AI Hiring	• AI can make hiring fairer ○ it may reduce human errors and bias • AI can reinforce or amplify inequality ○ unfair patterns can emerge if AI is trained on biased or poorly-designed data
Why These Beliefs Miss the Bigger Point	• AI doesn't just apply a definition of fairness; it locks in that definition when deployed • once fairness is built into scores, thresholds, or rules, it becomes the rule • local judgment, context, and human interpretation can be drowned out • key insights to fairness in hiring ○ is not singular ○ varies by role, team, context, and market ○ tends to "freeze" in on a singular understanding or idea
Practical Consequences	• consistency in decision-making • reduced noise from human variability • narrower candidate pools • human recruitment expertise gets sidelined

	• less flexibility for contextual hiring decisions
Lesson for Leaders	• avoid the question: “is AI fair?” • instead focus on: ○ what definition of fairness does this system use? ○ who decides that definition? ○ how often should we revisit it? ○ where do humans remain in the loop?
Article	
Women in tech and finance at higher risk from AI job losses, report says https://www.theguardian.com/business/2026/feb/04/women-tech-finance-higher-risk-ai-job-losses-report • <i>Harvard Business Review</i> 2026 • author: Joanna Partridge • women working in technology and financial services are at a higher risk of job loss due to AI and automation than men • ‘mid-career’ female workers also being sidelined by rigid hiring processes • City of London Corporation	
What the Report Found	• risk factors ○ jobs often held by women are more exposed to automation and AI tools ○ clerical and administrative roles ▪ mainly done by women ▪ face a high chance of disappearing as AI is adopted • mid-career women are especially impacted ○ women with about 5+ years experience are being overlooked for new digital opportunities ○ automated hiring systems can disadvantage people with career breaks
Numbers and Statistics	• ~119,000 clerical roles in tech and financial services may disappear due to automation over the next decade • helping women reskill for new roles could save companies about £757 million • up to 60,000 women leave tech roles each year for reasons including limited advancement and recognition

Discussion

Select an industry (e.g., construction, education, finance, **healthcare**) and examine the impact of AI-driven hiring on both employees and employers. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages, considering factors such as job roles, education and experience levels, as well as demographics like race, gender, ethnicity, and religion.

A quick search on Google Scholar reveals a large volume of papers on the effect of AI on human resource efforts in the healthcare industry. Randomly selecting three articles from the first page of results, only one of the papers offered any meaningful discussion of the ethical implications or bias risks. This was not the main focus of the paper, though at least it was given fair analysis.

My first thought was to check the publication dates: all were from 2023. I repeated the random selection, but this time I filtered for 2025 and 2026 publications only. As I suspected, this time all three mentioned ethical concerns, with one paper specifically focused on the ethical quandaries and another devoting a substantial portion of its research to issues including bias and displacement.

This suggests, at least circumstantially, that concern about the ethical implications of AI on the workforce and hiring practices is increasing. This is not surprising—given the rapid and accelerating advancement of agentic AI—that in only two years, public discussion of these emerging technologies has become more grounded in real-life implications and less focused on theory.

Burrell, D. N., & McAndrew, I. (2023). *Exploring the ethical dynamics of the use of artificial intelligence (AI) in hiring in healthcare organizations*. *Land Forces Academy Review*, 28(4), 309–321. <https://doi.org/10.2478/raft-2023-0037>

Koteczki, R., Csikor, D., & Balassa, B. E. (2025). The role of generative AI in improving the sustainability and efficiency of HR recruitment process. *Discover Sustainability*, 6(1). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s43621-025-01484-3>

Li, P., Bastone, A., Mohamad, T. A., & Schiavone, F. (2023). How does artificial intelligence impact human resources performance. evidence from a healthcare institution in the United Arab Emirates. *Journal of Innovation & Knowledge*, 8(2), 100340.

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jik.2023.100340>

Mohamad, T. A., Bastone, A., Bernhard, F., & Schiavone, F. (2023). How artificial intelligence impacts the competitive position of healthcare organizations. *Journal of Organizational Change Management*, 36(8), 49–70.

<https://doi.org/10.1108/jocm-03-2023-0057>

Tariq, M. U. (2025). AI and the Ethical Crossroads. In *Advances in human and social aspects of technology book series* (pp. 49–72).

<https://doi.org/10.4018/979-8-3693-9035-1.ch003>

Live Session Notes		30 Oct 2025
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